Information and Instructions for Usability Test

Information

You will be taking part in a usability test featuring an FAQ document. During this test you will analyze the document for its content and design. When you are done with your analysis of the document, you will complete a brief feedback form detailing what you learned, what about the document is effective and what could be improved.

Thank you for your time, feedback, and support!

Instructions

The following instructions have been provided to guide our users through the testing process:

1. **Read** through the FAQ in its entirety.
2. **Analyze** the FAQ for its content, grammar, design, and overall cohesion.
3. **Consider** these three questions: Do you understand the document--not only what it says, but what it is intended to do? Was it easy navigating the document? If required, would you be able to explain to another person how this document could be applied in a real-world scenario?
4. **Annotate** as needed! Feel free to make notes on your version of the FAQ for us to review.
5. **Provide feedback** through the given Google form.



What is TECHNICAL COMMUNICATION?

What is technical communication?

Technical communication is the process of taking complex information and making it clear, accessible, and easy to understand.

What career opportunities exist in this field?

The field is highly diverse. Technical Writer is a common title, but professionals work as web and graphic designers, writers, researchers, editors, and even grant writers.

Do I need a technical background to succeed?

Not at all! While subject matter knowledge is helpful, the most critical skill is the ability to analyze complex concepts and creatively translate and simplify them for a general audience.

Where do I see good technical communication?

Every time you assemble furniture without frustration, navigate an intuitive app, or watch a concise how-to tutorial, a technical communicator designed that experience.

What does a technical communicator do all day?

Rather than writing marketing or corporate buzzwords, practitioners spend the majority of their time researching, drafting, testing, and editing user-focused content.

An Overview of Technical Communication

Though technical communicators can take on many shapes, the overarching goal is to effectively communicate ideas and concepts to a specific audience.

The field was discovered during WWII when manuals were needed by the military to operate machinery. Since then, the need for technical communicators has grown into areas such as science, technology, government, healthcare, education, and finance.

Technical communicators work as translators, simplifiers, and connectors between complex information and people.

This document was created for a Texas State course group project during Fall 2026. 41/44 survey respondents revealed that they were unfamiliar with technical communication, indicating a significant gap between public perception and professional reality. All 41 respondents easily identified bad technical communication, most frequently citing unclear wording or jargon, confusing layouts, and poor or missing visuals/steps.